FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-25003

Issue Title : VNAV Disconnect Upon Raising the MCP Altitude For a Missed Approach when a Go-Around has been Performed

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3461-00	-10, -7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
08/24/2026	10/02/2026	08/28/2026
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
05/31/2028	11/20/2026	

Revision Description

Updated the following section(s):

- Applicability
- Description
- Status
- Interim Action
- Milestones

Applicability

Applies to all 737 MAX airplanes installed with GE Flight Management Computer (FMC) Operational Program Software (OPS) U14 or U14.1

Description

Boeing has received operator reports of a Vertical Navigation (VNAV) DISCONNECT on subsequent approach(s) after performing a Go-Around. VNAV would disengage upon setting the missed approach altitude into the Mode Control Panel (MCP).

The root cause has been determined and identified as the FMC is not transitioning between its defined TERMINAL and APPROACH Navigation Environment. The APPROACH environment is defined when the aircraft is within 2 NM of the initial approach fix in the FMC flight plan OR less than 2000 ft above the destination airport in descent phase. The TERMINAL environment is defined as the aircraft being below 15000 ft OR in Missed Approach AND not in the APPROACH environment. Normally, while on approach with VNAV engaged, VNAV stays engaged when MCP altitude is raised to the missed approach altitude, as long as the FMC is in the APPROACH Navigation Environment. This altitude is set on the MCP for the Autopilot Flight Director System (AFDS) to capture the missed approach altitude.

If the FMC flight plan is modified during a missed approach by selecting direct-to a waypoint not in the missed approach procedure nor in the following approach procedure, then the FMC will “latch” into the TERMINAL Navigation Environment. On subsequent VNAV-based approaches, VNAV will disconnect when the missed approach altitude is set on the MCP. This is due to the FMC not being in the APPROACH Navigation Environment which is required for VNAV staying engaged when the MCP altitude is raised while on approach.

The first approach to an airport is not affected and can be any type of approach loaded into the FMC. The anomaly does not

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occur if after the first missed approach ATC vectors are flown back to an approach procedure, OR if the entire published missed approach is flown (including the EXIT HOLD prompt on the CDU to exit the Missed Approach Hold, as applicable).

Additionally, the FMC being latched to the TERMINAL Navigation Environment affects the following FMC functions:

- For subsequent approaches, with the Takeoff/Go-Around (TO/GA) to LNAV option enabled, LNAV will not engage automatically. LNAV can be manually engaged after TO/GA. VNAV can be re-engaged immediately after TO/GA.
- Transitioning of the default Required Navigational Performance (RNP) vertical values will not automatically change to the APPROACH values. Manual lateral and vertical RNP entries will still be used properly. Lateral RNP values for legs coded in the Navigation Database will still be used properly.
- Due to this anomaly, the following FMC Messages would be suppressed:
  - UNABLE REQD NAV PERF-RNP (Specifically for vertical IRU comparison failures. The message still annunciates properly if ANP is greater than RNP).
  - FMC DISAGREE
  - APPRCH VREF NOT SELECTED
  - RW/APP TUNE DISAGREE and RW/APP COURSE ERROR
- If an uplink occurs, some FMC datalink messages may be annunciated, when they should normally be suppressed.

The attachment contains images illustrating the sequence of events that lead to the condition in GE FMC OPS U14 and U14.1, including the sequence of steps where VNAV disconnects. The attachment illustrates the sequence of events if the interim action is performed and also the sequence of events following incorporation of FMC OPS U14.2.

Status

This condition has been validated through extensive simulator testing in coordination with GE and its root cause has been determined. Boeing currently plans to incorporate a VNAV Software logic improvement to address this condition in FMC OPS U14.2.

This issue was reviewed as part of Boeing's in-service safety process and no further action has been deemed to be required to maintain the safety of the fleet. Boeing has developed flight crew guidance material based on operator feedback.

The issue was reviewed per FAA Corrective Action Review Board (CARB), which determined that it is not a safety concern.

Interim Action

There are no maintenance tasks to perform since the current software is working as implemented. Following a suspected occurrence of this issue, QAR data may be downloaded and sent to Boeing and GE Aviation for confirmation.

Reference Operations Manual Bulletin (OMB) PCR-3808 for additional information and mitigation.

Final Action

Incorporate FMS software update U14.2 via Service bulletin when available.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

FMC OPS U14.2 - 737 MAX - Certification | Schedule is in work.

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Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Flight Crew Operations Manual Bulletin (FCOMB)	PCR-3808		

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability
- Flight Operations : Flight Operations
- New Equipment : Information on new parts available now or soon to be introduced

Attachments:

a) VNAVDisconnectFollowingMissedApproach_U14-U14.1_SequenceOfEvents

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